

ParaPro Assessment Reading Section — Exam 1

PART A — QUESTIONS

PARAPRO1-001

Section: Full

Type: mcq

Category: Reading

Skill: Main idea

Prompt:

Read the passage.

During the first week of school, Ms. Alvarez asks students to keep a reading log. Each day, students write the title of what they read, the number of pages they completed, and one sentence about something they noticed. Ms. Alvarez explains that the log is not meant to be a race to read the most pages. Instead, it helps students notice their own reading habits and think about what helps them stay focused.

What is the main idea of the passage?

- A) Students should try to read more pages than their classmates.
- B) Reading logs help students track and reflect on their reading.
- C) Ms. Alvarez grades students mainly on the number of books they finish.
- D) Students should only read books chosen by the teacher.

PARAPRO1-002

Section: Full

Type: mcq

Category: Reading

Skill: Supporting detail

Prompt:

Read the passage.

The school cafeteria will begin serving breakfast at 7:30 a.m. instead of 7:45 a.m. Students who arrive early may enter through the side door near the gym. Breakfast will include fruit, milk, and a hot item each day. Students should finish eating before reporting to homeroom at 8:00 a.m.

According to the announcement, what should students do before reporting to homeroom?

- A) Pick up lunch forms from the office
- B) Enter through the front entrance
- C) Finish eating breakfast
- D) Meet outside the gym

PARAPRO1-003

Section: Full

Type: mcq

Category: Reading

Skill: Vocabulary in context

Prompt:

Read the sentence.

The class expected the science demonstration to be brief, but it became lengthy when several students asked thoughtful questions.

What does the word lengthy most nearly mean?

- A) Confusing
- B) Noisy
- C) Long
- D) Difficult

PARAPRO1-004

Section: Full

Type: mcq

Category: Reading

Skill: Inference

Prompt:

Read the passage.

Jamal checked the classroom clock and quickly placed his notebook, pencil, and library book into his backpack. He looked at the homework board one more time before joining the line at the door. "I do not want to forget the reading assignment again," he said.

What can be inferred about Jamal?

- A) He is preparing to leave class.
- B) He does not enjoy reading books.
- C) He plans to ask for a new seat.
- D) He has already finished all of his homework.

PARAPRO1-005

Section: Full

Type: mcq

Category: Reading

Skill: Author's purpose

Prompt:

Read the passage.

Please remember to return all permission slips by Friday. The museum visit cannot be finalized until the school has an accurate count of students attending. If a student needs another copy of the form, one may be picked up in the main office.

What is the author's main purpose?

- A) To entertain students with a story about a museum
- B) To persuade students that museums are better than classrooms
- C) To inform students about a deadline and procedure
- D) To compare different field trip locations

PARAPRO1-006

Section: Full

Type: mcq

Category: Reading

Skill: Text organization

Prompt:

Read the passage.

First, rinse the paintbrush in warm water. Next, gently press the bristles against a paper towel to remove extra water. Finally, place the brush with the handle down so the bristles can dry without bending.

How is the passage organized?

- A) By listing steps in order
- B) By comparing two different tools
- C) By describing a problem and solution
- D) By explaining causes and effects

PARAPRO1-007

Section: Full

Type: mcq

Category: Reading

Skill: Tone

Prompt:

Read the passage.

The hallway display looks much brighter now that students have added their book recommendation cards. Each card includes a title, a short summary, and a reason another student might enjoy the book. The display gives everyone a friendly way to discover something new to read.

Which word best describes the tone of the passage?

- A) Worried
- B) Encouraging
- C) Angry
- D) Uncertain

PARAPRO1-008

Section: Full

Type: mcq

Category: Reading

Skill: Summarizing

Prompt:

Read the passage.

The class planted bean seeds in small cups near the window. Some cups received water every day, while others received water only twice a week. Students recorded the height of each plant every Friday. After three weeks, they compared their notes to discuss how watering affected plant growth.

Which sentence best summarizes the passage?

- A) Students grew bean plants and compared how different watering schedules affected growth.
- B) Students learned that all plants should be watered only twice a week.
- C) Students moved plants away from the window after three weeks.
- D) Students measured plants every morning before class began.

PARAPRO1-009

Section: Full

Type: mcq
Category: Reading
Skill: Identifying evidence
Prompt:
Read the passage.

Mia prefers working in the quiet corner of the classroom during independent reading. When the class reads at their desks, she often looks around and loses her place. In the quiet corner, she follows the page with her finger and usually finishes the assigned pages.

Which detail best supports the idea that the quiet corner helps Mia focus?

- A) Mia prefers working in the quiet corner of the classroom during independent reading.
- B) When the class reads at their desks, she often looks around and loses her place.
- C) In the quiet corner, she follows the page with her finger and usually finishes the assigned pages.
- D) The class reads at their desks during independent reading.

PARAPRO1-010
Section: Full
Type: mcq
Category: Reading
Skill: Interpreting informational text
Prompt:
Read the notice.

Book Club Meeting
Tuesday, 3:15–4:00 p.m.
Room 204

Bring the book you are currently reading. Students will share one favorite part and listen to recommendations from classmates. Snacks will not be served, so students should eat before the meeting.

What should students bring to the meeting?

- A) A signed permission slip
- B) A book they are currently reading
- C) A snack to share with classmates
- D) A list of homework assignments

PARAPRO1-011
Section: Full
Type: mcq
Category: Reading
Skill: Inference
Prompt:
Read the passage.

When the class entered the room, the desks had been pushed into groups of four. Each group had a stack of index cards, markers, and a timer. On the board, the teacher had written, “Review Game: Work as a team.”

What can the reader reasonably infer?

- A) The students will take a silent test.

- B) The students will work together on an activity.
- C) The teacher forgot to prepare materials.
- D) The class will go outside for recess.

PARAPRO1-012

Section: Full

Type: mcq

Category: Reading

Skill: Vocabulary in context

Prompt:

Read the passage.

Lena revised her paragraph after receiving feedback. She replaced vague words like “things” and “stuff” with more specific nouns. Her final draft was clearer because readers could picture exactly what she meant.

What does vague mean in the passage?

- A) Not clear or specific
- B) Carefully written
- C) Too short to understand
- D) Correctly spelled

PARAPRO1-013

Section: Full

Type: mcq

Category: Reading

Skill: Main idea

Prompt:

Read the passage.

A school garden can be useful even when classes are not studying plants. Math students can measure garden beds and calculate area. Art students can sketch leaves and flowers. Writing students can keep observation journals. Because of this, the garden gives many classes a hands-on place to learn.

What is the main idea of the passage?

- A) A school garden can support learning in several subjects.
- B) Art students should spend more time drawing plants.
- C) Garden beds must be measured before students use them.
- D) Observation journals are the most important classroom activity.

PARAPRO1-014

Section: Full

Type: mcq

Category: Reading

Skill: Author's purpose

Prompt:

Read the passage.

Our class will collect clean plastic bottle caps for a counting project next month. Please send only bottle caps that have been washed and dried. Students will sort the caps by color, count each group, and use the totals to make simple graphs.

Why did the author most likely write this note?

- A) To explain how plastic bottles are made
- B) To ask families to send a specific classroom material
- C) To describe why graphs are difficult for students
- D) To tell students to stop using plastic bottles

PARAPRO1-015

Section: Full

Type: mcq

Category: Reading

Skill: Text organization

Prompt:

Read the passage.

Many students find it hard to keep track of long-term assignments. One solution is to break a large task into smaller parts. A student might choose a topic on Monday, find sources on Tuesday, write notes on Wednesday, and draft a paragraph on Thursday.

Which organizational pattern does the passage mainly use?

- A) Cause and effect
- B) Problem and solution
- C) Compare and contrast
- D) Chronological biography

PARAPRO1-016

Section: Full

Type: mcq

Category: Reading

Skill: Supporting detail

Prompt:

Read the passage.

The after-school homework room is open Monday through Thursday from 3:10 p.m. to 4:00 p.m. Students may work quietly, ask for help, or use classroom reference books. Computers are available only for school assignments. Students must sign in when they arrive.

Which activity is allowed in the homework room?

- A) Playing computer games after finishing work
- B) Using classroom reference books
- C) Meeting friends for loud group games
- D) Leaving without signing in

PARAPRO1-017

Section: Full

Type: mcq

Category: Reading

Skill: Fact and opinion

Prompt:

Read the sentences.

1. The class read three poems on Wednesday.
2. The poem about the ocean was the most beautiful.
3. Each student chose one poem to discuss.
4. The discussion lasted twenty minutes.

Which sentence states an opinion?

- A) The class read three poems on Wednesday.
- B) The poem about the ocean was the most beautiful.
- C) Each student chose one poem to discuss.
- D) The discussion lasted twenty minutes.

PARAPRO1-018

Section: Full

Type: mcq

Category: Reading

Skill: Interpreting directions

Prompt:

Read the directions.

Before beginning the quiz, write your name on the answer sheet. Read each question carefully. Choose the best answer and fill in the matching circle. If you finish early, check your work quietly until time is called.

What should students do if they finish early?

- A) Begin talking with a neighbor
- B) Leave the room immediately
- C) Check their work quietly
- D) Turn the quiz over and draw

PARAPRO1-019

Section: Full

Type: mcq

Category: Reading

Skill: Inference

Prompt:

Read the passage.

The class pet's water bowl was empty when Nora arrived in the morning. The classroom calendar showed that Nora was the helper for Tuesday. She filled the bowl before putting away her backpack.

What can the reader infer?

- A) Nora forgot that she was the classroom helper.
- B) Nora knew she was responsible for helping with the class pet.
- C) The class pet does not need water every day.
- D) The teacher asked Nora to clean the calendar.

PARAPRO1-020

Section: Full

Type: mcq

Category: Reading

Skill: Summarizing

Prompt:

Read the passage.

In the late afternoon, the school hallway becomes busy. Students return library books, gather instruments for music lessons, and collect projects from classrooms. Teachers remind students to walk carefully because many people are moving in different directions at once.

Which sentence best summarizes the passage?

- A) Students should not visit the library in the afternoon.
- B) The hallway is busy after school, so students need to move carefully.
- C) Music lessons are the most popular after-school activity.
- D) Teachers collect all student projects at the end of the day.

PARAPRO1-021

Section: Full

Type: mcq

Category: Reading

Skill: Supporting student comprehension

Prompt:

A paraprofessional is helping a student read a short passage about how a caterpillar becomes a butterfly. The student says, "I read all the words, but I do not know what happened first."

Which support would best help the student understand the sequence?

- A) Ask the student to list the events in the order they happened
- B) Tell the student to skip the passage and choose an answer quickly
- C) Ask the student to count how many sentences are in the passage
- D) Tell the student to memorize the longest word in the passage

PARAPRO1-022

Section: Full

Type: mcq

Category: Reading

Skill: Helping students use context clues

Prompt:

A student reads the sentence, "The hallway was congested after the assembly because several classes were leaving at the same time." The student does not know the word congested.

Which question should a paraprofessional ask to guide the student to use context clues?

- A) "Can you spell the word without looking?"
- B) "What was happening in the hallway after the assembly?"
- C) "Have you seen this word in a science textbook?"
- D) "Which letter comes first in the word?"

PARAPRO1-023

Section: Full

Type: mcq

Category: Reading

Skill: Identifying evidence

Prompt:

A student says that a character in a story is nervous before giving a class presentation. The passage says, “Evan shuffled his note cards, took a deep breath, and looked down when his name was called.”

Which detail best supports the student’s idea?

- A) Evan had note cards.
- B) Evan took a deep breath and looked down when his name was called.
- C) Evan was in a classroom.
- D) Evan’s name was called.

PARAPRO1-024

Section: Full

Type: mcq

Category: Reading

Skill: Selecting a reading support strategy

Prompt:

A student reads a paragraph correctly but cannot explain the main idea. The teacher has asked the paraprofessional to help the student during small-group practice.

Which strategy would be most appropriate?

- A) Ask the student to identify what most of the sentences are about
- B) Give the student a harder paragraph immediately
- C) Tell the student the answer without discussing the text
- D) Ask the student to copy the paragraph three times

PARAPRO1-025

Section: Full

Type: mcq

Category: Reading

Skill: Supporting comprehension of informational text

Prompt:

A student is reading a short article with the heading “How Weather Affects Recess Plans.” The student is unsure what the article will be mostly about.

Which prompt would best help the student use the heading?

- A) “What do you think this article will explain based on the heading?”
- B) “How many letters are in the heading?”
- C) “Can you rewrite the heading in cursive?”
- D) “Which word in the heading is the shortest?”

PARAPRO1-026

Section: Full

Type: mcq

Category: Reading

Skill: Helping students summarize

Prompt:

A student writes this summary of a passage about a class recycling project: “The class had bins. The bins were blue. I like blue bins.”

Which feedback would best help the student improve the summary?

- A) "Add every detail from the passage so the summary is longer."
- B) "Focus on the most important idea and leave out personal opinions."
- C) "Change the topic to something more interesting."
- D) "Use only words that are shorter than five letters."

PARAPRO1-027

Section: Full

Type: mcq

Category: Reading

Skill: Distinguishing fact from opinion

Prompt:

During reading practice, a student identifies the sentence "The new playground opened on Monday" as an opinion.

What should the paraprofessional say to support understanding?

- A) "That sentence can be checked, so it is a fact."
- B) "That sentence is an opinion because it includes a day of the week."
- C) "All sentences about school are opinions."
- D) "A fact always tells how someone feels."

PARAPRO1-028

Section: Full

Type: mcq

Category: Reading

Skill: Supporting rereading for evidence

Prompt:

A student answers a question about a passage but cannot explain why the answer is correct. The teacher has directed students to support answers with text evidence.

What should the paraprofessional encourage the student to do?

- A) Choose a different answer without looking back
- B) Reread the passage and point to the sentence that supports the answer
- C) Ask another student to give the answer
- D) Erase the answer and leave the question blank

PARAPRO1-029

Section: Full

Type: mcq

Category: Reading

Skill: Supporting vocabulary development

Prompt:

A student reads, "The coach gave a brief explanation before practice began." The student thinks brief means "angry."

Which response would best help the student check the meaning?

- A) "Look at the rest of the sentence. Would an explanation before practice more likely be short or angry?"
- B) "Always guess the first meaning that comes to mind."
- C) "Skip every sentence with an unknown word."
- D) "Brief is not important, so do not think about it."

PARAPRO1-030

Section: Full

Type: mcq

Category: Reading

Skill: Supporting reading-group discussion

Prompt:

A paraprofessional is assisting a teacher during a small reading-group discussion. One student gives an answer but does not refer to the passage.

Which question would best encourage the student to connect the answer to the text?

A) “Can you show us where the passage gives that information?”

B) “Do you want to stop reading now?”

C) “Why did you choose that seat today?”

D) “Can you answer without looking at the page?”

PART B — ANSWER KEY + EXPLANATIONS

PARAPRO1-001 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: Reading logs help students track and reflect on their reading. — Explanation: The passage explains that the log helps students notice reading habits and think about focus, not compete over page totals.

PARAPRO1-002 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: Finish eating breakfast — Explanation: The announcement says students should finish eating before reporting to homeroom at 8:00 a.m.

PARAPRO1-003 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: Long — Explanation: The sentence contrasts brief with lengthy, so lengthy means long.

PARAPRO1-004 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: He is preparing to leave class. — Explanation: Jamal packs his materials and joins the line at the door, which shows he is getting ready to leave.

PARAPRO1-005 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: To inform students about a deadline and procedure — Explanation: The passage gives information about when permission slips are due and where to get another copy.

PARAPRO1-006 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: By listing steps in order — Explanation: The words First, Next, and Finally show that the directions are organized as steps.

PARAPRO1-007 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: Encouraging — Explanation: The passage presents the display positively and says it helps students discover new books.

PARAPRO1-008 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Students grew bean plants and compared how different watering schedules affected growth. — Explanation: This choice includes the main activity and purpose of the experiment without adding unnecessary details.

PARAPRO1-009 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: In the quiet corner, she follows the page with her finger and usually finishes the assigned pages. — Explanation: This detail directly shows that Mia stays on task and completes her reading in the quiet corner.

PARAPRO1-010 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: A book they are currently reading — Explanation: The notice clearly says students should bring the book they are currently reading.

PARAPRO1-011 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: The students will work together on an activity. — Explanation: The grouped desks, shared materials, timer, and board message all suggest a team activity.

PARAPRO1-012 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Not clear or specific — Explanation: The passage contrasts vague words with more specific nouns that make the writing clearer.

PARAPRO1-013 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: A school garden can support learning in several subjects. — Explanation: The passage gives examples of how math, art, and writing classes can all use the garden.

PARAPRO1-014 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: To ask families to send a specific classroom material — Explanation: The note asks families to send clean, dry bottle caps for a class project.

PARAPRO1-015 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: Problem and solution — Explanation: The passage first states a problem, then gives a solution for managing long-term assignments.

PARAPRO1-016 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: Using classroom reference books — Explanation: The passage says students may use classroom reference books in the homework room.

PARAPRO1-017 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: The poem about the ocean was the most beautiful. — Explanation: The word beautiful expresses a personal judgment, so the sentence is an opinion.

PARAPRO1-018 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: Check their work quietly — Explanation: The directions state that students who finish early should check their work quietly until time is called.

PARAPRO1-019 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: Nora knew she was responsible for helping with the class pet. — Explanation: Nora sees she is the Tuesday helper and fills the empty water bowl, showing she understands her responsibility.

PARAPRO1-020 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: The hallway is busy after school, so students need to move carefully. — Explanation: This summary captures both the busy hallway and the teacher's reminder to walk carefully.

PARAPRO1-021 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Ask the student to list the events in the order they happened — Explanation: Since the student is confused about what happened first, arranging events in order directly supports understanding sequence.

PARAPRO1-022 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: "What was happening in the hallway after the assembly?" — Explanation: This question directs the student back to the surrounding words, which explain that several classes were leaving at once.

PARAPRO1-023 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: Evan took a deep breath and looked down when his name was called. — Explanation: Taking a deep breath and looking down are details that can suggest nervousness before a presentation.

PARAPRO1-024 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Ask the student to identify what most of the sentences are about — Explanation: Looking for what most sentences are about helps a student determine the main idea.

PARAPRO1-025 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: “What do you think this article will explain based on the heading?” — Explanation: This prompt helps the student use the heading to predict the topic of the article.

PARAPRO1-026 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: “Focus on the most important idea and leave out personal opinions.” — Explanation: A summary should include the central idea of the passage, not unrelated personal opinions.

PARAPRO1-027 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: “That sentence can be checked, so it is a fact.” — Explanation: Whether the playground opened on Monday can be verified, which makes the sentence a fact.

PARAPRO1-028 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: Reread the passage and point to the sentence that supports the answer — Explanation: Rereading and pointing to supporting text helps the student connect the answer to evidence.

PARAPRO1-029 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: “Look at the rest of the sentence. Would an explanation before practice more likely be short or angry?” — Explanation: This response guides the student to use context to choose the meaning that makes sense.

PARAPRO1-030 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: “Can you show us where the passage gives that information?” — Explanation: This question encourages the student to support an answer by referring directly to the text.